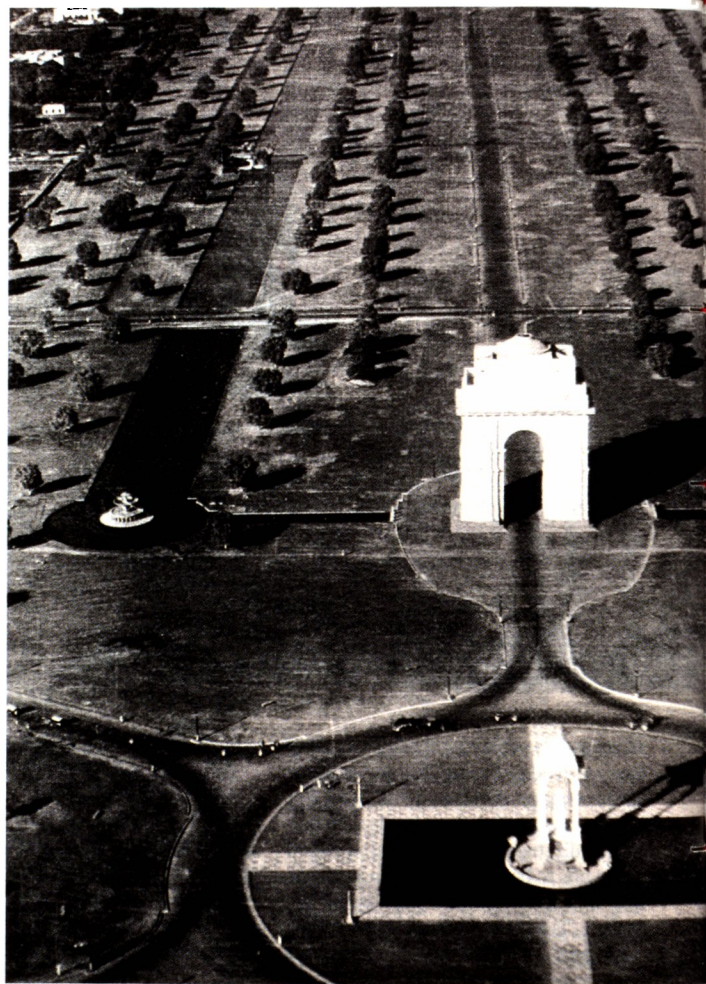


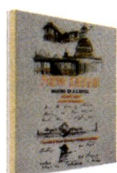


(ABOVE) SIR HERBERT BAKER AND EDWIN LUTYENS RIDING THROUGH RAISINA; A WATERCOLOUR OF THE STATE BALLROOM IN GOVERNMENT HOUSE, NOW RASHTRAPATI BHAVAN'S ASHOKA HALL (BELOW)



Deconstructing DELHI

The brick-by-brick celebration of a city and its makers in imperial sepia



NEW DELHI: MAKING OF A CAPITAL
by MALVIKA SINGH AND
RUDRANGSHU MUKHERJEE
Concept and Research:
PRAMOD KAPOOR
Lustre Press/Roli
Price: Rs 1,975
Pages: 240

| By Dilip Bobb |

Seven dynasties and seven cities left behind enough buried treasure for archaeologists and historians to fill libraries and museums. Yet, it was the eighth city—and the eighth dynasty—that would produce the grandest city of them all. Delhi, in its modern avatar as the capital of independent India, is the

most enduring legacy left behind by the British, its imperial splendour hidden behind frenetic construction for the Commonwealth Games, another British legacy. No other Indian city has been so exhaustively documented and it would seem unlikely that there is place for yet another book on Delhi. Enter Pramod Kapoor. The publisher of Roli Books could qualify as an archaeologist, with his uncanny ability to unearth